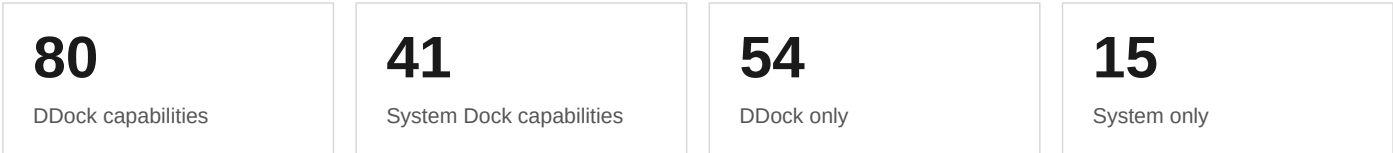


# DDock and the system Dock

Feature comparison - 11 September 2026 - current DDock on main, including Quarantine (DEE-46) - macOS Dock on the Tahoe and macOS 27 lineage

DDock currently offers 80 user-facing capabilities. The system Dock offers 41 at the same grain. DDock leads by 39. The lead is not even. It comes from extras, workspaces, per-display control, and window tools. The system Dock still owns minimize, Spaces assignment, native badges, and the one-dock-follows-you model.



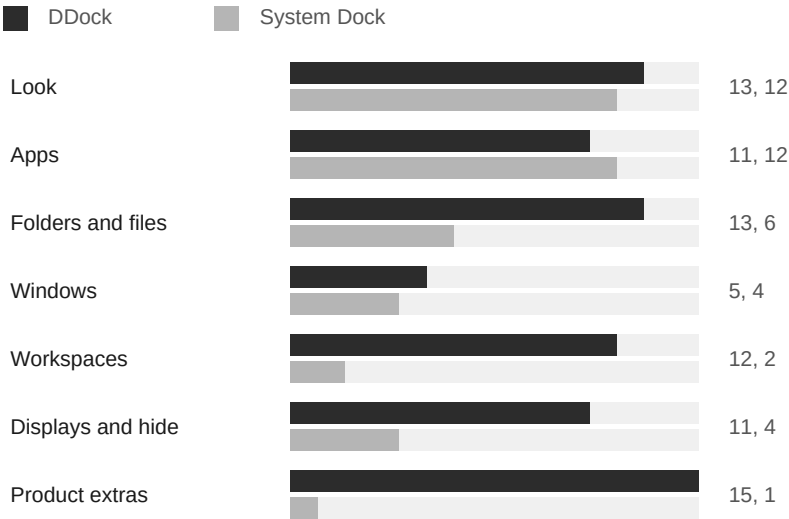
## How these numbers were counted

One capability is one feature. Style galleries, sliders, and delays inside a capability do not add to the count. Running indicators is one feature, not eight. Stage Manager, widgets, hot corners, Mission Control, and window tiling sit next to the Dock in Desktop and Dock settings. They are omitted. Withdrawn Metal indicators and Debug-only inspectors are omitted. Planned work is omitted, including Fan stacks, pin multi-select, recipe window layout, and coexistence controls.

Sources for DDock: README, Settings pages, and docs/ACCEPTANCE.md. Sources for the system Dock: Apple Desktop and Dock settings plus standard Dock interactions. Of 95 compared capabilities, 18 sit on both sides, 8 overlap only in part, 54 are DDock only, and 15 are system only. 26 of the 95 exist in some form on both products.

## Capabilities by category

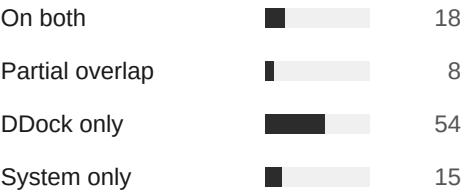
Count of capabilities present on each product. Source: inventory below. Current DDock versus the macOS Dock.



Category, capabilities (count). Bars are scaled to 15, the largest single-product category total.

### Overlap

Share of the 95 compared capabilities.



## Category totals

| Category          | DDock     | System    | Both      | Partial  | DDock only | System only |
|-------------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|----------|------------|-------------|
| Look              | 13        | 12        | 5         | 3        | 5          | 4           |
| Apps              | 11        | 12        | 7         | 0        | 4          | 5           |
| Folders and files | 13        | 6         | 5         | 1        | 7          | 0           |
| Windows           | 5         | 4         | 0         | 0        | 5          | 4           |
| Workspaces        | 12        | 2         | 0         | 2        | 10         | 0           |
| Displays and hide | 11        | 4         | 1         | 1        | 9          | 2           |
| Product extras    | 15        | 1         | 0         | 1        | 14         | 0           |
| <b>Total</b>      | <b>80</b> | <b>41</b> | <b>18</b> | <b>8</b> | <b>54</b>  | <b>15</b>   |

A capability counted under Both or Partial appears in both product totals.  $18 + 8 + 54 = 80$  DDock.  $18 + 8 + 15 = 41$  system Dock.

## DDock only

### 54 capabilities

#### Look

- Item spacing
- Corner radius
- Background visibility
- Idle fading
- Overflow scrolling

#### Apps

- Cross-display pin copy
- Pin on Display
- Window list in app menus
- App suggestions in Launcher

#### Folders and files

- Quick Look in stacks
- Stack file and folder metadata
- Utility tile reorder
- Shelf
- Paste clipboard into Shelf
- Open Files picker
- Peek file handoff

#### Windows

- Window Peek
- Watch this
- Window portals
- App Fusion
- Find a Window

#### Workspaces

- Dock Modes
- Workspace recipes
- Session Capsules

- Breadcrumbs
- Focus Sessions
- Boss Fight
- Action Tiles
- Ask Robi
- Launcher file actions
- Local History

#### Displays and hide

- Alignment, offset, and distance
- Usable-desktop versus screen-edge reference
- Independent dock per display
- Per-display setting inheritance
- Remembered disconnected displays
- Visible-window satellite docks
- Activation zones
- Hide and reveal animation styles
- App visibility hide or collapse

#### Product extras

- Badge memory
- Atmosphere
- Pin Weather
- Clipboard Museum
- Magnetic Edges
- Dock Sims
- Soap Bubbles
- Quarantine stamp
- First-launch tour
- Launch DDock at login
- Menu-bar extra
- Software updates
- Own running-icon policy
- Permissions UI

## System Dock only

### 15 capabilities

#### Look

- Icon and Widget Style. System Settings, Appearance. Clear and Tinted apply to the Dock.
- Hidden-app dimming
- Attention bouncing
- Icon progress bars

#### Apps

- Show All Windows
- Open at Login from the icon
- Assign to Desktop
- Suggested and recent apps in the dock
- Recent documents in dock menus

#### Windows

- Minimize targets in the dock
- Minimize animation

- Minimize into application icon
- Title-bar double-click action

**Displays and hide**

- Dock follows the active display
- Full-screen Spaces hide

## Full inventory

Partial means both products have a version, and the implementations are not equivalent.

| Capability                                       | Category | Status      | Note                                                             |
|--------------------------------------------------|----------|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Liquid Glass chrome                              | Look     | Both        |                                                                  |
| Icon size                                        | Look     | Both        |                                                                  |
| Item spacing                                     | Look     | DDock only  |                                                                  |
| Magnification                                    | Look     | Both        |                                                                  |
| Corner radius                                    | Look     | DDock only  |                                                                  |
| Running indicators                               | Look     | Partial     | DDock: 8 styles. System: dot on or off.                          |
| App launch animations                            | Look     | Partial     | DDock: 6 styles. System: bounce on or off.                       |
| App-name labels                                  | Look     | Partial     | DDock: 17 presets. System: classic hover name.                   |
| Background visibility                            | Look     | DDock only  |                                                                  |
| Idle fading                                      | Look     | DDock only  |                                                                  |
| Overflow scrolling                               | Look     | DDock only  | System shrinks icons when the dock is crowded.                   |
| Hover without stealing focus                     | Look     | Both        |                                                                  |
| VoiceOver, Reduce Motion,<br>Reduce Transparency | Look     | Both        |                                                                  |
| Icon and Widget Style                            | Look     | System only | System Settings, Appearance. Clear and Tinted apply to the Dock. |
| Hidden-app dimming                               | Look     | System only |                                                                  |
| Attention bouncing                               | Look     | System only |                                                                  |
| Icon progress bars                               | Look     | System only |                                                                  |
| Pin apps                                         | Apps     | Both        |                                                                  |
| Running-only apps                                | Apps     | Both        |                                                                  |
| Drag-and-drop reorder                            | Apps     | Both        |                                                                  |
| Drag apps in from Finder                         | Apps     | Both        |                                                                  |
| Cross-display pin copy                           | Apps     | DDock only  |                                                                  |
| Drag-off unpin                                   | Apps     | Both        |                                                                  |
| Pin on Display                                   | Apps     | DDock only  |                                                                  |
| Click to open, activate, or hide                 | Apps     | Both        |                                                                  |
| Application context menus                        | Apps     | Both        |                                                                  |
| Window list in app menus                         | Apps     | DDock only  |                                                                  |
| Show All Windows                                 | Apps     | System only |                                                                  |
| Open at Login from the icon                      | Apps     | System only |                                                                  |
| Assign to Desktop                                | Apps     | System only |                                                                  |
| Suggested and recent apps in the dock            | Apps     | System only |                                                                  |
| Recent documents in dock menus                   | Apps     | System only |                                                                  |
| App suggestions in Launcher                      | Apps     | DDock only  |                                                                  |

|                                   |                   |             |                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------|-------------------|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Folder stacks                     | Folders and files | Partial     | DDock: Grid, List, or Smart. System: Fan, Grid, List, or Automatic.              |
| Spring-loaded folders             | Folders and files | Both        |                                                                                  |
| Quick Look in stacks              | Folders and files | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| Stack file and folder metadata    | Folders and files | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| Downloads tile                    | Folders and files | Both        |                                                                                  |
| Utility tile reorder              | Folders and files | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| Shelf                             | Folders and files | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| Paste clipboard into Shelf        | Folders and files | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| Trash                             | Folders and files | Both        |                                                                                  |
| Drop files on apps                | Folders and files | Both        |                                                                                  |
| Open Files picker                 | Folders and files | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| Peek file handoff                 | Folders and files | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| Drop or copy into folders         | Folders and files | Both        |                                                                                  |
| Window Peek                       | Windows           | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| Watch this                        | Windows           | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| Window portals                    | Windows           | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| App Fusion                        | Windows           | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| Find a Window                     | Windows           | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| Minimize targets in the dock      | Windows           | System only |                                                                                  |
| Minimize animation                | Windows           | System only |                                                                                  |
| Minimize into application icon    | Windows           | System only |                                                                                  |
| Title-bar double-click action     | Windows           | System only |                                                                                  |
| Dock Modes                        | Workspaces        | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| Workspace recipes                 | Workspaces        | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| Session Capsules                  | Workspaces        | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| Breadcrumbs                       | Workspaces        | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| Focus Sessions                    | Workspaces        | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| Boss Fight                        | Workspaces        | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| Action Tiles                      | Workspaces        | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| App Launcher and Apps icon        | Workspaces        | Partial     | DDock: browse, unified search, Ask Robi. System: Tahoe Apps icon into Spotlight. |
| Ask Robi                          | Workspaces        | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| Launcher file actions             | Workspaces        | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| Local History                     | Workspaces        | DDock only  |                                                                                  |
| Focus Dock and Move focus to Dock | Workspaces        | Partial     | DDock: Focus Dock. System: Control-F3.                                           |
| Edge placement                    | Displays and hide | Partial     | DDock: bottom, top, left, or right. System: left, bottom, or right.              |
| Alignment, offset, and distance   | Displays and hide | DDock only  |                                                                                  |

|                                                |                   |             |                                                                     |
|------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Usable-desktop versus<br>screen-edge reference | Displays and hide | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| Independent dock per display                   | Displays and hide | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| Per-display setting inheritance                | Displays and hide | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| Remembered disconnected<br>displays            | Displays and hide | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| Visible-window satellite docks                 | Displays and hide | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| Auto-hide                                      | Displays and hide | Both        |                                                                     |
| Activation zones                               | Displays and hide | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| Hide and reveal animation styles               | Displays and hide | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| App visibility hide or collapse                | Displays and hide | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| Dock follows the active display                | Displays and hide | System only |                                                                     |
| Full-screen Spaces hide                        | Displays and hide | System only |                                                                     |
| App badges                                     | Product extras    | Partial     | DDock mirrors Accessibility badge text. System draws native badges. |
| Badge memory                                   | Product extras    | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| Atmosphere                                     | Product extras    | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| Pin Weather                                    | Product extras    | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| Clipboard Museum                               | Product extras    | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| Magnetic Edges                                 | Product extras    | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| Dock Sims                                      | Product extras    | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| Soap Bubbles                                   | Product extras    | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| Quarantine stamp                               | Product extras    | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| First-launch tour                              | Product extras    | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| Launch DDock at login                          | Product extras    | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| Menu-bar extra                                 | Product extras    | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| Software updates                               | Product extras    | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| Own running-icon policy                        | Product extras    | DDock only  |                                                                     |
| Permissions UI                                 | Product extras    | DDock only  |                                                                     |

## What this is not

This is a capability count, not a quality score. The system Dock still owns minimize, Spaces assignment, native badges, and the one-dock model. DDock's lead is mostly extras, workspaces, per-display control, and window tools. Counting sliders and presets separately, or adding Desktop and Dock neighbors, would change the totals.